Locked-in

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/51256672.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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F/F

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Catra (She-Ra), Adora (She-Ra)

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Season 2, Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Catra Has Issues (She-Ra), POV Catra (She-Ra), Drunk Adora (She-Ra), Emotional Hurt, Canon Compliant, Useless Lesbians, Episode "White Out", Heartbreak, challenge

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by Lyssandia

Summary

What the hell went wrong? Catra thought Adora would be easy to handle while she was infected with this weird disk-virus thing.
But nothing, nothing went according to the plan.

Notes

This one-shot is part of a server-challenge we made on discord, the task is:
"Write a short story about drunk (corrupted) Adora in the Northern Reach, stuck in a storage room with Catra! Around 2k words! We'll all share them!"

So that's where the idea came from and I'm gad I managed to write it! I'm actually happy how it turned out, although it's unfortunately not a happy end here. I decided to stay true to canon, so there's no way this would have one.
Get some tissues!
And I hope you'll still enjoy reading this story.

I'm most grateful to dear Pixiepepistar for beta-reading this and correcting my messy English. Thank you so much!

This is for Altecfenix and all members of our server.

See the end of the work for more notes

"Waaaaaaah!" Catra's own yell rang in her ears as she shoved Adora into whatever room was in front of her and then jumped inside herself. She successfully closed and locked the door just in time before the elemental bumped into it, screeching angrily when it lost sight of its prey. Her heart nearly stopped in panic when she heard it claw at the door, but then there was a loud noise further away and everything fell silent.

"Shit, that was close!" The feline needed to catch her breath before she finally paid attention to the room she just escaped into with her former friend. "Great. I found the storage room," she sighed, her gaze falling onto some crates and boxes.

A giggle-snort made her look at Adora, who was lying on the floor and seemed to be enjoying herself.

"What the fuck is wrong with you?" Catra cried out in frustration. "You're not brain-damaged now, are you?" She squatted down beside the blonde and examined her closely, but to her relief she couldn't see any wounds on Adora.

What the hell went wrong? Catra thought Adora would be easy to handle while she was infected with this weird disk-virus thing. But nothing, *nothing* went according to the plan.

First, She-Ra had been way stronger than anticipated. Second, she had turned into a goofy goon when she turned back into Adora. Third, those weird elemental monsters appeared out of nowhere and attacked them!

All Catra could do to save her own ass (and Adora’s, of all people!) was run away until she came up with a plan.

Stars, she hated this stupid ice-cold place!

"Oooooooh…. you look like…. like…. my best friend…," Adora cooed stupidly when she finally took her time to look up.

"Tsssk," Catra hissed. "We're not friends anymore, Adora!"

"Aaaaw." Adora sounded disappointed.

Catra rolled her eyes and scanned the room once more. There was a small window above one of the shelves. If needed, she could probably climb up there and escape. Her ears turned toward the door again, but it was still silent outside. She was pretty sure the elemental wasn’t there anymore, but she didn't want to run into a trap either.

Curious, she got up again and went over to the door to peek outside. She typed the unlock code into the panel, but when she tried to open the door, it didn't move. "What? Why is it still locked?" Catra tried again, but the door stayed locked.

"Maybe you need Catra’s favorite number!" Adora helpfully suggested. "Don't you know her favorite number?" She got up, a melody on her lips, and pushed all the right buttons to Catra’s surprise.

"You remember my favorite number?" She asked, her face showing her incredulity.

"Of course I do! She’s my best friend!" Adora proudly said, then giggle-snorted again.

"Pfff," Catra replied. But even with the correct number, the door didn’t open. "Great, looks like that monster broke the electronics," she sighed. Facepalming, she realized what that meant. "Guess I'm stuck here with you!"

Adora laughed and laid down on the floor again, clearly not realizing the seriousness of the situation.

Catra growled in frustration, but she didn't want to leave the blonde on her own or lose her, now that she finally had control of her! The disk was still safely tucked away in her pocket, but seeing that dork drooling while apparently napping on the floor fed Catra’s insecurity.

Was this really what she wanted? Was this how she wanted Adora back? That dumbass wasn’t really *her* Adora. And she’d still need

to figure out how to control that red-veined berserk She-Ra if she ever hoped to use her against her enemies.

"Shit," she cursed to herself, feeling the lump that had formed in her throat. Did Adora really still consider her a friend? Did she still mean something to the blonde? Catra had thought that Adora hated her. That she was worthless to her. At least worthless enough to not even try to come back for her. It still hurt her to know that Adora had voluntarily surrendered herself to Shadow Weaver to help that damn, sparkly princess. She came to save Glimmer, but she never came back for *her* .

"I'm not worth saving, right Adora? Just like Shadow Weaver said. I'm only a nuisance." Although Adora was snoring too loudly to hear those words, it still hurt to say them out loud. It was hard to hold back the tears that threatened to roll down her cheeks. Sobbing, she let herself slide against the door down to the floor and hugged her own knees, her tail tightly coiled around herself. Her head rested on her knees and with a sigh, she closed her eyes.

"Catra?"

The feline couldn't say how much time had passed before she woke up to someone calling to her. She looked up and saw directly into the oh so blue eyes of Adora.

"Are you crying, Catra?" Adora asked, concern in her voice.

"Tssk, of course not!" Catra snarled, irritated by the care that Adora seemed to show.

To her surprise, Adora pouted. "You're lying! I see the tears on your cheeks!"

That was the moment when Catra noticed that this was still infected Adora. She sighed again, using her sleeves to wipe her face.

"Why are you so sad?" Adora asked, poking her finger into Catra's side, a bit like she did as a child years ago.

The playful gesture made Catra giggle involuntarily. The giggle almost became a sob a second later though, when she considered her answer. "Because I miss you so much," she confessed honestly. This "drunk" Adora wouldn't know any better anyway, right? No need to lie.

"But I'm right here!" Adora proclaimed.

"But we're enemies now…," Catra whispered. It wasn't like she ever *wanted* to be enemies with her best friend.

"I don't want to be enemies! You'll always be my friend, Catra!" The agitated blonde nearly yelled.

"I wish I could believe you," Catra wailed, shaking her head.

A second later, she felt Adora’s strong arms embracing her tightly, her warmth melting away the cold that Catra had felt for so long.

"Don't you know that I love you, Catra?" She heard Adora’s voice whispering in her twitching ear. She couldn't prevent her tail from curling around Adora.

"You… do…?" Catra whispered back, blushing, but not really believing what she heard. The feline didn’t even dare to breathe, it just felt so unreal.

"I do," Adora assured her.

Her heart beat fast in her chest, faster and louder than it ever had. How long had she hoped to hear that sentence? How long did she wait to say those words herself?

They looked at each other, both with reddened, flushed faces, when suddenly Adora moved and tenderly closed the gap between their lips.

"Oooh!" A deep sigh escaped Catra and she automatically closed her eyes, feeling those amazingly soft lips on her own.

This was all she ever wanted. All she ever dreamed of! All she ever needed!

It was like a gentle fire that engulfed her whole body, while a shiver simultaneously ran down her spine and tail.

When she felt Adora’s tongue asking to be let in, she opened her mouth willingly, not able to hold back her own desire anymore. She noticed a weird sound and needed way too long to recognize it as her own, content purr. It had been ages since she’d purred like that!

Their tongues were dancing with each other for quite some time and her heart ached for so much more when they eventually parted again, both panting and red.

Catra stared at Adora’s flushed face, saw how happy the blonde looked, and smiled; an honest smile for the first time since they became enemies.

But then reality set in again when she became aware of their surroundings once more and the weight of the disk was heavy in her pocket.

She didn't want Adora back like this.

"Is it true…?" she asked, whispering her words into the room. "Would you really want me like that, even if you’re not under the influence of this?" Catra took the disk out and stared at it, her hope already vanishing.

"Ohhh, that’s pretty!" Adora cheered with sparkly eyes. "Can I have it?"

Catra scoffed, knowing Adora still wasn't herself. "When you’re back to normal, you'll hate me again, right? I can never have the things I wish for."

Anger flooded her, mixed with disappointment. She felt new tears running down her face, unabated. With a loud, livid yell, she stood up and smashed the disk on the floor where it shattered into countless smithereens, along with most of her hope.

Adora yelped for a second then fell to the floor, needing some time to come to her senses again.

When she looked up, Catra was standing next to her. Her desperate face still wet with tears.

"You hate me, don’t you, Adora?!" She sneered, although she didn't really mean it. The feline’s eyes were filled with sorrow and grief.

"Catra… what… where….?" Adora tried to find out what was going on, but Catra's expression and her question startled her. "Why would you think that?"

"I'm not worth it, am I? To leave the rebellion or the princesses?" Catra asked, disgruntled.

Adora's face hardened. "If you think I'd ever come back to the Horde, then I have to disappoint you! The Horde is wrong and you know it, Catra!"

"You grew up in the Horde, too. How could you not notice how they were sooner?" Catra accused, sounding upset. Her tail thrashed violently behind her. "How could you be this blind?"

"Shadow Weaver manipulated me! But at least I defected the moment I realized the Horde was evil! How can you be okay with anything they do?" Adora asked back, her face red from the anger she began to feel.

"I didn't care about what they did as long as I had you!" Catra confessed angrily.

Adora was taken aback a bit by that, but she couldn't see it the same way as her former best friend. "People get hurt by the Horde. I can't just look away now. I need to save Etheria!"

Catra scoffed cheerlessly, her expression bitter. "I knew it. I was never enough for you. You never cared about me." The feline's heart broke once more when that realization set in, but she didn't plan on staying behind so that Adora could laugh at her foolish hopes. It hurt her to know that Adora cared more about people she didn't even know than she ever did about her. Did she ever realize how many times Catra got hurt by Shadow Weaver?

It didn't matter anymore. Adora made her choice.

Without another word, Catra hopped on top of the shelf and vanished through the small window, leaving only sadness behind.

"Catra?! Wait!" Adora cried, hoping the feline would turn back or stay. But Catra had always been fast. She was gone. Along with all her hope to rekindle their friendship.

End Notes

Thank you so much for reading this little story!
Did you like it?
Did I stay true to canon?
Did I nail the characters?

Please leave some feedback. ;-)

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!